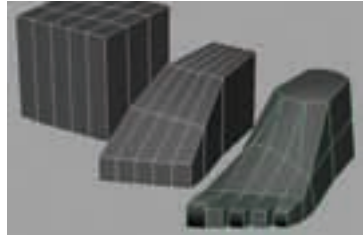


the mesh or some part of the mesh, these rings are called Edge loops. Edge loops are especially practical in organic models which need to be animated. Take a model of a face for example. If the edge loops follow the contours of where the muscles would be then the face will deform much more smoothly compared to when the edges would be place arbitrarily.



Box modeling

Subdividing

You can always add or subtract edges from a polygon mesh. Subdividing is a method of increasing the number of vertices as well as the polygons by adding edges across the mesh. You can simply subdivide your mesh, or you can subdivide and smooth. Smoothing averages out the vertices thus reducing sharp angles in the model. There are different techniques of subdividing Catmull-Clark Subdivision and Doo-Sabine and triangle division etc. Creating characters that come alive on screen is the primary reason that modeling with subdivision surfaces was developed.



Extrusion modeling



Mirroring

Taking care of polygon count

The polygon count is an important aspect of a mesh. The larger the polygon count, the more detail it will have. But it will also take more processing power to manipulate the mesh. This means the more polygons you have, the longer it will take to render. With the right hardware, none of this may be an issue. However, if you are modeling for games, you may very well have limits. In fact, some games have the same model with different levels of detail, keeping low-polygon models when they are far from the camera and vice-versa.



Edge Loops